



By spending time with women who are also expecting a baby, you can share the ups and downs of your pregnancy experiences.

OLDER MOMS

The number of women over 40 becoming pregnant continues to increase. According to the Centers for Disease Control, the birth rate for women over 40 has risen in recent years. Women over 40 were responsible for more than 10 in 1,000 births in 2016. The average age for pregnancy in the US is between the ages of 30 and 34.

ASK A DOCTOR

I've been told I have carpal tunnel syndrome. What is it? This condition occurs when swollen tissues in the wrist compress the nerves and cause pins and needles and numbness in your fingers. You may also have difficulty grasping and a weakness in the hands. In pregnancy, it's caused by an increase in blood volume and fluid. There are ways to reduce the symptoms, such as circling and stretching exercises to improve circulation and increase wrist mobility. Wearing wrist splints and elevating your hands on a pillow at night can also help. Carpal tunnel syndrome resolves after the birth, once there is no longer excess fluid.